Challenges of Nation Building

Q1. Who delivered the famous 'Tryst with Destiny' speech on the midnight of 14–15 August 1947?

(A) Dr Rajendra Prasad
(B) Mahatma Gandhi
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Q2. Which of the following was one of the three major challenges faced by independent India?

(A) Establishing a one-party system of government
(B) Retaining the British Constitution without change
(C) Ensuring the development and well-being of the entire society, not just some sections
(D) Joining a military alliance with a superpower

Q3. According to the 'two-nation theory' advocated by the Muslim League, who were separate nations?

(A) North Indians and South Indians
(B) Rulers and the ruled
(C) Hindus and Muslims
(D) Indians and the British

Q4. Which two provinces of British India were divided on the basis of religious majorities in 1947?

(A) Bombay and Madras
(B) Punjab and Bengal
(C) Assam and Bihar
(D) Sindh and Baluchistan

Q5. Who was known as the 'Frontier Gandhi' and opposed the two-nation theory?

(A) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(B) Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
(C) Muhammad Ali Jinnah
(D) Sheikh Abdullah

Q6. How does the chapter describe the movement of people across the new borders at Partition?

(A) A voluntary migration limited to a few cities
(B) A temporary movement that ended within a month
(C) The largest, most abrupt, unplanned and tragic transfer of population in human history
(D) A smooth and well-planned exchange of population

Q7. Which organisation was temporarily banned after the assassination of Mahatma Gandhi in January 1948?

(A) Communist Party of India
(B) Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)
(C) Muslim League
(D) Indian National Congress

Q8. Approximately how many princely states existed in British India at the time of independence?

(A) About 900
(B) About 565
(C) About 100
(D) About 250

Q9. What did the British government declare about the princely states when it left India?

(A) All princely states would automatically join India
(B) All princely states would automatically join Pakistan
(C) They would be governed directly by the United Nations
(D) British paramountcy over them would lapse and they were free to join India or Pakistan, or remain independent

Q10. Who played the leading role in the integration of the princely states into India?

(A) Maulana Azad
(B) Dr B. R. Ambedkar
(C) C. Rajagopalachari
(D) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Q11. By signing which document did the rulers of princely states agree to join the Indian Union?

(A) Treaty of Friendship
(B) Instrument of Accession
(C) Instrument of Partition
(D) Cabinet Mission Plan

Q12. In which princely state did the people vote in a plebiscite to join India despite the ruler's wish to join Pakistan?

(A) Manipur
(B) Hyderabad
(C) Travancore
(D) Junagadh

Q13. The Nizam of which princely state wanted independence, and was brought into India after military action in September 1948?

(A) Junagadh
(B) Kashmir
(C) Hyderabad
(D) Mysore

Q14. Which was the first state in India to hold elections under universal adult franchise after the Maharaja's decision, in June 1948?

(A) Sikkim
(B) Hyderabad
(C) Manipur
(D) Tripura

Q15. Which French colonial territory was integrated into India in 1954?

(A) Goa
(B) Diu
(C) Daman
(D) Pondicherry

Q16. What was the result of the 1967 'Opinion Poll' in Goa?

(A) Goa chose to remain a separate Union Territory rather than merge with Maharashtra
(B) Goa chose to merge with Maharashtra
(C) Goa chose to merge with Karnataka
(D) Goa chose to become independent

Q17. At which session did the Indian National Congress commit itself, in 1920, to the formation of linguistic states?

(A) Nagpur session
(B) Lahore session
(C) Bombay session
(D) Karachi session

Q18. Why were national leaders initially reluctant to accept the demand for linguistic states after independence?

(A) They feared it could lead to disintegration of the country
(B) They wanted to retain the British provinces permanently
(C) They believed language had no role in politics
(D) The Constitution prohibited linguistic states

Q19. Whose fast unto death in 1952 for a separate Telugu-speaking state led to the creation of Andhra?

(A) Potti Sriramulu
(B) K. Kamaraj
(C) Vinoba Bhave
(D) Sheikh Abdullah

Q20. The States Reorganisation Commission of 1953 was headed by:

(A) Fazl Ali
(B) Sardar Patel
(C) H. N. Kunzru
(D) K. M. Panikkar

Q21. The States Reorganisation Act of 1956 created how many states and union territories?

(A) 10 states and 2 union territories
(B) 16 states and 4 union territories
(C) 20 states and 10 union territories
(D) 14 states and 6 union territories

Q22. In 1960, the bilingual state of Bombay was divided into which two states?

(A) Maharashtra and Gujarat
(B) Maharashtra and Karnataka
(C) Gujarat and Rajasthan
(D) Maharashtra and Goa

Q23. Which state was divided in 1966 to create Haryana (and transfer some areas to Himachal Pradesh)?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Punjab
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q24. According to the Constitution, for how many years was English to continue to be used for official purposes along with Hindi?

(A) 15 years
(B) 50 years
(C) 25 years
(D) 5 years

Q25. Which state witnessed strong agitation against the imposition of Hindi as the official language?

(A) Assam
(B) Punjab
(C) Gujarat
(D) Tamil Nadu (Madras)

Era of One-Party Dominance

Q1. The Election Commission of India was set up in:

(A) August 1947
(B) January 1952
(C) November 1949
(D) January 1950

Q2. Who was the first Chief Election Commissioner of India?

(A) S. L. Shakdher
(B) K. V. K. Sundaram
(C) Sukumar Sen
(D) T. N. Seshan

Q3. The first general elections to the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies were held in:

(A) 1947–48
(B) 1962
(C) 1957
(D) 1951–52

Q4. How many Lok Sabha seats were contested in the first general election?

(A) 520
(B) 543
(C) 400
(D) 489

Q5. How did the Election Commission deal with the problem of illiterate voters in the first general election?

(A) Illiterate voters were not allowed to vote
(B) A separate ballot box with the candidate's election symbol was placed for each candidate
(C) Voting was done by raising hands
(D) Voters had to name the candidate aloud

Q6. What was the approximate voter turnout in the first general election?

(A) About 61 per cent
(B) About 85 per cent
(C) About 25 per cent
(D) About 40 per cent

Q7. In the first general election the Congress won how many of the 489 Lok Sabha seats?

(A) 250
(B) 420
(C) 364
(D) 289

Q8. Which party emerged as the second largest in the first Lok Sabha, with 16 seats?

(A) Socialist Party
(B) Communist Party of India
(C) Swatantra Party
(D) Bharatiya Jana Sangh

Q9. The Congress won about 45 per cent of votes but nearly three-fourths of the seats in 1952 mainly because of:

(A) The proportional representation system
(B) Reservation of seats for the Congress
(C) Boycott of elections by other parties
(D) The first-past-the-post (single member plurality) electoral system

Q10. The term 'Congress System' to describe Congress dominance is associated with:

(A) Rajni Kothari
(B) Jayaprakash Narayan
(C) Acharya Narendra Dev
(D) Ram Manohar Lohia

Q11. The Indian National Congress was formed in:

(A) 1857
(B) 1920
(C) 1885
(D) 1905

Q12. Which group, formed within the Congress in 1934, left it in 1948 to form the Socialist Party?

(A) Forward Bloc
(B) Hindu Mahasabha
(C) Congress Socialist Party
(D) Swaraj Party

Q13. Which party was formed by Dr B. R. Ambedkar and contested the 1952 elections?

(A) Bahujan Samaj Party
(B) Republican Party of India
(C) Peasants and Workers Party
(D) Scheduled Castes Federation

Q14. Which state elected the first non-Congress government in India, headed by E. M. S. Namboodiripad, in 1957?

(A) Madras
(B) Kerala
(C) West Bengal
(D) Orissa

Q15. The Communist government in Kerala was dismissed in 1959 using which provision?

(A) Article 356
(B) Article 352
(C) Article 368
(D) Article 370

Q16. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was formed in 1951 under the leadership of:

(A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(B) Syama Prasad Mukherjee
(C) L. K. Advani
(D) Deendayal Upadhyaya

Q17. Which slogan was associated with the Bharatiya Jana Sangh?

(A) Jai Jawan Jai Kisan
(B) Hindi, Hindu, Hindustan
(C) Land to the Tiller
(D) Garibi Hatao

Q18. The Swatantra Party, formed in 1959, was led by:

(A) C. Rajagopalachari
(B) Morarji Desai
(C) Charan Singh
(D) Jawaharlal Nehru

Q19. The Swatantra Party was known for supporting:

(A) Free enterprise and opposing land ceilings and state control of the economy
(B) Soviet-style centralised planning
(C) Nationalisation of all industries
(D) Collective farming

Q20. In 1964, which party split, giving rise to the CPI(M)?

(A) Bharatiya Jana Sangh
(B) Communist Party of India
(C) Praja Socialist Party
(D) Socialist Party

Q21. Which of the following was a prominent leader of the Socialist Party?

(A) Syama Prasad Mukherjee
(B) C. Rajagopalachari
(C) Ram Manohar Lohia
(D) Sardar Patel

Q22. Which party remained in power in Mexico for about sixty years, an example of one-party dominance?

(A) Labour Party
(B) National Action Party
(C) Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI)
(D) Democratic Party

Q23. How is India's one-party dominance different from that in countries like China, Cuba or Syria?

(A) It was achieved in a democratic setup through free and fair multi-party competition
(B) The Congress was the only legal party
(C) Elections were not held
(D) Other parties were banned by law

Q24. Jawaharlal Nehru passed away in:

(A) May 1964
(B) January 1966
(C) October 1969
(D) August 1962

Q25. Which of the following best describes the Congress party in the early decades after independence?

(A) A party representing only one caste
(B) A party restricted to urban areas
(C) A party based on a single ideology
(D) A broad 'rainbow-like' coalition of different social groups and ideologies

Politics of Planned Development

Q1. The Planning Commission of India was set up in:

(A) April 1956
(B) March 1950
(C) August 1947
(D) January 1952

Q2. Who was the ex-officio Chairperson of the Planning Commission?

(A) The Finance Minister
(B) The Prime Minister
(C) The Chief Justice
(D) The President

Q3. The Planning Commission was set up by:

(A) An Act of Parliament
(B) An order of the Supreme Court
(C) A resolution of the Union Cabinet
(D) A constitutional amendment

Q4. The 'Bombay Plan' of 1944 was a blueprint for:

(A) Setting up a planned economy in India, drawn up by leading industrialists
(B) Nationalisation of banks
(C) Land reforms in Bombay
(D) The partition of India

Q5. A 'mixed economy' means:

(A) Trade is allowed only with neighbouring countries
(B) Only private firms operate
(C) Both the public and private sectors play a role in the economy
(D) Only the state owns all industries

Q6. The First Five Year Plan (1951–56) gave the highest priority to:

(A) Foreign trade
(B) Heavy industries
(C) Defence manufacturing
(D) Agriculture, irrigation and power projects

Q7. Which economist is associated with the drafting of the First Five Year Plan?

(A) K. N. Raj
(B) Manmohan Singh
(C) P. C. Mahalanobis
(D) Amartya Sen

Q8. The Second Five Year Plan (1956–61) emphasised:

(A) Rapid industrialisation, especially heavy industries
(B) Only agriculture
(C) Only education
(D) Only small-scale industries

Q9. The Second Five Year Plan is associated with which statistician-planner?

(A) Verghese Kurien
(B) P. C. Mahalanobis
(C) Homi Bhabha
(D) Vinoba Bhave

Q10. Which country's planning experience inspired India's Five Year Plans?

(A) France
(B) United States
(C) Soviet Union
(D) Japan

Q11. Which of the following was an early land reform measure after independence?

(A) Abolition of the zamindari system
(B) Privatisation of all land
(C) Abolition of agriculture tax on the rich
(D) Introduction of the zamindari system

Q12. 'Land ceiling' refers to:

(A) Buying land by the government at any price
(B) Banning land sale
(C) Fixing minimum price for land
(D) Fixing a maximum limit on the land an individual or family can own

Q13. Consolidation of land holdings meant:

(A) Transferring land to the state
(B) Merging villages
(C) Dividing large farms into small plots
(D) Bringing together scattered small plots of a farmer into one compact holding

Q14. The Bhoodan movement was started by:

(A) Vinoba Bhave
(B) Jayaprakash Narayan
(C) Mahatma Gandhi
(D) Charan Singh

Q15. The Green Revolution of the 1960s mainly involved the use of:

(A) Cooperative farming only
(B) Organic manure only
(C) Handloom technology
(D) High-yielding variety seeds, fertilisers and irrigation

Q16. The Green Revolution mainly benefited which crop and regions?

(A) Rice in Kerala
(B) Cotton in Gujarat only
(C) Wheat in Punjab, Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh
(D) Jute in Bengal

Q17. The food crisis of the 1960s forced India to depend on food aid under which US programme?

(A) PL 480
(B) Lend-Lease
(C) Point Four
(D) Marshall Plan

Q18. A major negative consequence of the Green Revolution was:

(A) Fall in wheat production
(B) Complete end of rural poverty
(C) Widening of regional and economic disparities
(D) Ban on irrigation

Q19. Operation Flood, the 'White Revolution', is associated with:

(A) Verghese Kurien
(B) Vinoba Bhave
(C) M. S. Swaminathan
(D) P. C. Mahalanobis

Q20. Which cooperative dairy in Gujarat became the model for Operation Flood?

(A) Aavin
(B) Amul (Anand)
(C) Nandini
(D) Mother Dairy

Q21. The 'Plan Holiday' of 1966–69 happened because of:

(A) Nationalisation of banks
(B) Absence of a Planning Commission
(C) Success of the Green Revolution
(D) Wars with China and Pakistan, droughts and resource shortages

Q22. During the Plan Holiday, how many annual plans were drawn up?

(A) None
(B) Three annual plans
(C) Five annual plans
(D) One annual plan

Q23. The Intensive Agricultural District Programme focused on:

(A) Backward and drought-prone areas only
(B) Forest regions
(C) Areas with assured irrigation and better prospects of higher yields
(D) Urban industrial centres

Q24. In 2015 the Planning Commission was replaced by:

(A) National Development Council
(B) NITI Aayog
(C) Election Commission
(D) Finance Commission

Q25. Which of the following was a main goal of the early planning in India?

(A) Complete dependence on foreign aid
(B) Closing the economy to all trade
(C) Rapid privatisation of all industries
(D) Economic growth with social justice and reduction of inequality

India's External Relations

Q1. Which Article of the Directive Principles of State Policy directs the State to promote international peace and security?

(A) Article 51
(B) Article 21
(C) Article 370
(D) Article 44

Q2. Who served as both Prime Minister and External Affairs Minister of India during 1947–64?

(A) Sardar Patel
(B) Indira Gandhi
(C) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(D) Jawaharlal Nehru

Q3. The policy of non-alignment means:

(A) Staying away from the military blocs led by the USA and the USSR
(B) Isolating India from the world
(C) Allying with the USA
(D) Allying with the USSR

Q4. India refused to join which of the following US-led military alliances?

(A) Commonwealth
(B) Warsaw Pact
(C) United Nations
(D) SEATO and CENTO

Q5. Which of the following leaders was a founder of the Non-Aligned Movement along with Nehru?

(A) Mao Zedong
(B) Winston Churchill
(C) Charles de Gaulle
(D) Josip Broz Tito

Q6. The first summit of the Non-Aligned Movement was held in 1961 at:

(A) New Delhi
(B) Cairo
(C) Belgrade
(D) Bandung

Q7. The Asian Relations Conference, hosted by India, was held in:

(A) 1961
(B) March 1947
(C) August 1947
(D) 1955

Q8. The Afro-Asian Conference of 1955 was held at:

(A) Belgrade
(B) Colombo
(C) Bandung (Indonesia)
(D) Cairo

Q9. The Panchsheel agreement of 1954 was signed between India and:

(A) Nepal
(B) China
(C) Soviet Union
(D) Pakistan

Q10. Which event in 1959 added to the tension between India and China?

(A) The Dalai Lama sought asylum in India
(B) The first nuclear test by India
(C) The Bangladesh war
(D) The Tashkent Agreement

Q11. The Sino-Indian war of 1962 was fought mainly over which areas?

(A) Siachen and Kargil
(B) Sikkim and Bhutan
(C) Aksai Chin (Ladakh) and the North-East Frontier Agency (Arunachal Pradesh)
(D) Rann of Kutch

Q12. What political consequence did the 1962 war with China have in India?

(A) The first no-confidence motion was moved against the government in the Lok Sabha
(B) Emergency was declared
(C) The Congress won all seats in the next election
(D) The Constitution was suspended

Q13. The Indus Waters Treaty of 1960 was signed by Nehru and Ayub Khan with the mediation of:

(A) The Commonwealth
(B) The Soviet Union
(C) The World Bank
(D) The United Nations Security Council

Q14. The Tashkent Agreement (January 1966) ended the war of 1965 between India and Pakistan. It was signed by Lal Bahadur Shastri and:

(A) Sheikh Mujibur Rahman
(B) Zulfikar Ali Bhutto
(C) Ayub Khan
(D) Yahya Khan

Q15. Which Indian Prime Minister died in Tashkent in January 1966?

(A) Jawaharlal Nehru
(B) Gulzarilal Nanda
(C) Morarji Desai
(D) Lal Bahadur Shastri

Q16. The crisis of 1971 in East Pakistan began after the victory in the 1970 elections of:

(A) Zulfikar Ali Bhutto's People's Party
(B) The Jamaat-e-Islami
(C) Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's Awami League
(D) The Muslim League

Q17. In August 1971 India signed a Treaty of Peace and Friendship with:

(A) The Soviet Union
(B) China
(C) Bangladesh
(D) The United States

Q18. The Simla Agreement of 1972 was signed by Indira Gandhi and:

(A) Nawaz Sharif
(B) Zulfikar Ali Bhutto
(C) Ayub Khan
(D) Yahya Khan

Q19. India conducted its first nuclear test at Pokhran in 1974 under:

(A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(B) Jawaharlal Nehru
(C) Rajiv Gandhi
(D) Indira Gandhi

Q20. India opposed the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) because it:

(A) Banned nuclear energy for peaceful uses in all countries
(B) Was discriminatory, legitimising the nuclear arsenals of the five powers only
(C) Was signed only by India's neighbours
(D) Was never discussed at the UN

Q21. India conducted a second set of nuclear tests at Pokhran in May 1998 under Prime Minister:

(A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(B) Manmohan Singh
(C) I. K. Gujral
(D) P. V. Narasimha Rao

Q22. Which conflict took place in 1999 in the Kargil sector of Jammu and Kashmir?

(A) India–China conflict
(B) India–Pakistan conflict
(C) India–Sri Lanka conflict
(D) India–Bangladesh conflict

Q23. Which event of 1991 deeply affected India's foreign policy by ending the bipolar world order?

(A) Disintegration of the Soviet Union
(B) Construction of the Berlin Wall
(C) Formation of NATO
(D) End of the Korean War

Q24. SAARC, an organisation for regional cooperation among South Asian countries, was established in:

(A) 1947
(B) 1985
(C) 1999
(D) 1971

Q25. Which scientist is associated with launching India's nuclear programme in the 1940s–50s?

(A) S. Chandrasekhar
(B) Vikram Sarabhai
(C) C. V. Raman
(D) Homi J. Bhabha

Challenges to and Restoration of the Congress System

Q1. Who became the Prime Minister of India after Jawaharlal Nehru's death in 1964?

(A) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(B) Morarji Desai
(C) Indira Gandhi
(D) Gulzarilal Nanda

Q2. Which slogan is associated with Lal Bahadur Shastri?

(A) Garibi Hatao
(B) Sampoorna Kranti
(C) Hindi, Hindu, Hindustan
(D) Jai Jawan Jai Kisan

Q3. Who were the two main contenders for the Prime Ministership in 1966?

(A) Jagjivan Ram and Y. B. Chavan
(B) Indira Gandhi and Morarji Desai
(C) Morarji Desai and Charan Singh
(D) Indira Gandhi and Kamaraj

Q4. Indira Gandhi was chosen as leader of the Congress Parliamentary Party in 1966 by a secret ballot, by a margin of:

(A) 355 votes to 169
(B) 400 votes to 100
(C) 250 votes to 200
(D) 300 votes to 250

Q5. The group of powerful Congress leaders from different states who played a key role in choosing the leader after Nehru was called the:

(A) Grand Alliance
(B) Samyukta Vidhayak Dal
(C) Janata Front
(D) Syndicate

Q6. Which of the following was a member of the Congress 'Syndicate'?

(A) George Fernandes
(B) Charu Majumdar
(C) K. Kamaraj
(D) Ram Manohar Lohia

Q7. In the 1967 Lok Sabha elections the Congress:

(A) Won all seats
(B) Won a reduced majority of 283 out of 520 seats
(C) Did not contest
(D) Lost power at the Centre

Q8. The strategy of uniting all non-Congress parties to defeat the Congress is known as:

(A) Non-Congressism
(B) Secularism
(C) Gandhism
(D) Non-alignment

Q9. Which party came to power in Madras (Tamil Nadu) in 1967 under C. N. Annadurai?

(A) All India Anna DMK
(B) Congress
(C) Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK)
(D) Swatantra Party

Q10. Coalitions of non-Congress parties formed in several states after 1967 were called:

(A) National Front
(B) United Front
(C) Grand Alliance
(D) Samyukta Vidhayak Dal (SVD)

Q11. The phrase 'Aya Ram, Gaya Ram' refers to:

(A) A land reform scheme
(B) Frequent defections by legislators from one party to another
(C) A religious procession
(D) A Hindi film

Q12. Which Haryana MLA became famous for changing parties three times in a fortnight in 1967?

(A) Bhajan Lal
(B) Aya Ram
(C) Devi Lal
(D) Gaya Lal

Q13. In the 1969 Presidential election, Indira Gandhi supported which candidate against the Congress's official candidate N. Sanjiva Reddy?

(A) Zakir Husain
(B) C. D. Deshmukh
(C) V. V. Giri
(D) S. Radhakrishnan

Q14. After the 1969 split, the Congress divided into:

(A) Congress (U) and Congress (A)
(B) Congress (I) and Congress (S)
(C) Congress (J) and Congress (K)
(D) Congress (O) and Congress (R)

Q15. In July 1969 Indira Gandhi's government nationalised:

(A) Insurance companies only
(B) All banks in India
(C) 14 major private commercial banks
(D) Only the Reserve Bank

Q16. Which privileges of former princes were abolished in 1971?

(A) Voting rights
(B) Titles of Maharaja
(C) Privy purses
(D) Ownership of temples

Q17. Indira Gandhi took away the Finance portfolio from which senior leader in 1969?

(A) Morarji Desai
(B) Jagjivan Ram
(C) Y. B. Chavan
(D) Kamaraj

Q18. The 'Grand Alliance' in the 1971 Lok Sabha elections was formed by:

(A) Congress (R) and CPI
(B) Regional parties of the South
(C) Congress (O), Swatantra Party, Bharatiya Jana Sangh and other non-Left opposition parties
(D) Only the Left parties

Q19. The election slogan 'Garibi Hatao' was given by:

(A) Morarji Desai
(B) Indira Gandhi
(C) Jayaprakash Narayan
(D) Atal Bihari Vajpayee

Q20. The opposition's slogan against Indira Gandhi in 1971 was:

(A) Indira Hatao
(B) Jai Jawan Jai Kisan
(C) Total Revolution
(D) Garibi Hatao

Q21. How many Lok Sabha seats did the Congress (R) win in the 1971 elections?

(A) 283
(B) 154
(C) 415
(D) 352

Q22. What was unusual about the 1971 Lok Sabha elections?

(A) They were boycotted by the Congress
(B) They were held early, separately from the State Assembly elections
(C) They were held after the Emergency
(D) They were held only in the North

Q23. After the Bangladesh war of 1971, the Congress won decisively in which elections?

(A) The 1977 Lok Sabha elections
(B) The 1972 State Assembly elections
(C) The 1967 Lok Sabha elections
(D) The 1952 elections

Q24. Which socialist leader strongly advocated the strategy of non-Congressism in the 1960s?

(A) Ram Manohar Lohia
(B) Kamaraj
(C) Morarji Desai
(D) C. Rajagopalachari

Q25. Indira Gandhi's political style after 1971 was based mainly on:

(A) Direct appeal to the people, bypassing the party organisation
(B) Collective leadership of the Syndicate
(C) Withdrawal from active politics
(D) Reliance on regional parties

The Crisis of Democratic Order

Q1. Which international event in 1973 led to a sharp rise in prices in India?

(A) Collapse of the Soviet Union
(B) Fall of the Berlin Wall
(C) Sharp increase in oil prices
(D) The Korean War

Q2. The Naxalite movement began in 1967 in:

(A) Chhotanagpur, Bihar
(B) Telangana, Andhra Pradesh
(C) Mizo Hills, Assam
(D) Naxalbari, West Bengal

Q3. Who was a leading figure of the Naxalite movement and the CPI (Marxist–Leninist)?

(A) Charu Majumdar
(B) E. M. S. Namboodiripad
(C) Harkishan Singh Surjeet
(D) Jyoti Basu

Q4. The 1974 Navnirman movement against corruption and price rise took place in:

(A) Bihar
(B) Gujarat
(C) Kerala
(D) Punjab

Q5. Which senior leader went on a fast in Gujarat in 1974, forcing fresh elections to the Assembly?

(A) Morarji Desai
(B) Biju Patnaik
(C) Jagjivan Ram
(D) Charan Singh

Q6. The 1974 movement in Bihar was led by:

(A) Vinoba Bhave
(B) Acharya Kripalani
(C) Ram Manohar Lohia
(D) Jayaprakash Narayan

Q7. Jayaprakash Narayan's call for transformation of Indian society was known as:

(A) Total Revolution (Sampoorna Kranti)
(B) Quit India
(C) White Revolution
(D) Green Revolution

Q8. The 1974 nationwide railway strike was led by:

(A) George Fernandes
(B) Raj Narain
(C) Morarji Desai
(D) Jayaprakash Narayan

Q9. In which case did the Supreme Court propound the 'basic structure' doctrine of the Constitution in 1973?

(A) Shah Bano case
(B) Kesavananda Bharati case
(C) Minerva Mills case
(D) Golaknath case

Q10. In 1973 A. N. Ray was appointed Chief Justice of India by:

(A) Election by judges
(B) Following the seniority rule
(C) Superseding three senior judges
(D) A resolution of Parliament

Q11. Whose election to the Lok Sabha from Rae Bareli did the Allahabad High Court set aside in June 1975?

(A) Morarji Desai
(B) Jagjivan Ram
(C) Raj Narain
(D) Indira Gandhi

Q12. Who was the petitioner who challenged Indira Gandhi's election in the Allahabad High Court?

(A) Jayaprakash Narayan
(B) Charan Singh
(C) Raj Narain
(D) George Fernandes

Q13. Which judge of the Allahabad High Court delivered the verdict against Indira Gandhi's election on 12 June 1975?

(A) Justice A. N. Ray
(B) Justice Jagmohanlal Sinha
(C) Justice P. N. Bhagwati
(D) Justice H. R. Khanna

Q14. The Emergency was declared on the night of 25–26 June 1975 under which Article of the Constitution?

(A) Article 356
(B) Article 368
(C) Article 360
(D) Article 352

Q15. On what ground was the Emergency of 1975 declared?

(A) Internal disturbances
(B) External aggression
(C) Financial crisis
(D) Failure of constitutional machinery in a state

Q16. Who was the President of India who issued the Emergency proclamation in 1975?

(A) V. V. Giri
(B) N. Sanjiva Reddy
(C) Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed
(D) Zakir Husain

Q17. Which of the following happened during the Emergency?

(A) Press censorship and preventive detention of opposition leaders
(B) Freedom of the press was expanded
(C) All political prisoners were released
(D) General elections were held as scheduled

Q18. The 42nd Amendment (1976) extended the term of the Lok Sabha from five years to:

(A) Four years
(B) Ten years
(C) Six years
(D) Seven years

Q19. In the Habeas Corpus case (ADM Jabalpur v. Shivkant Shukla), the Supreme Court held that during the Emergency:

(A) Press censorship must end
(B) The Emergency was unconstitutional
(C) All detentions were illegal
(D) Detained persons could not seek release through courts by enforcing fundamental rights

Q20. The Twenty-Point Programme was announced during the Emergency to:

(A) Show commitment to socio-economic reforms and justify the Emergency
(B) Hold elections early
(C) Dismiss state governments
(D) Reduce the powers of the President

Q21. Which Congress President coined the slogan 'Indira is India, India is Indira'?

(A) Kamaraj
(B) D. K. Barooah
(C) Jagjivan Ram
(D) S. Nijalingappa

Q22. The Janata Party won how many Lok Sabha seats (with allies) in the 1977 elections?

(A) 400
(B) 330
(C) 154
(D) 283

Q23. Who became Prime Minister at the head of the first non-Congress government at the Centre in March 1977?

(A) Charan Singh
(B) Morarji Desai
(C) Jagjivan Ram
(D) Chandra Shekhar

Q24. Which senior Congress leader left the party in early 1977 and formed the 'Congress for Democracy'?

(A) Y. B. Chavan
(B) Kamaraj
(C) Morarji Desai
(D) Jagjivan Ram

Q25. The Shah Commission was appointed in 1977 to inquire into:

(A) The 1971 war
(B) The Bihar movement
(C) Excesses committed during the Emergency
(D) Corruption in banks

Regional Aspirations

Q1. Which Article of the Constitution gave special status to Jammu and Kashmir?

(A) Article 356
(B) Article 371
(C) Article 370
(D) Article 352

Q2. Who was the ruler of Jammu and Kashmir at the time of accession to India in 1947?

(A) Sheikh Abdullah
(B) Maharaja Hari Singh
(C) Maharaja Bodhachandra Singh
(D) Nizam Osman Ali Khan

Q3. The National Conference, the major party of Kashmir, was led by:

(A) Ghulam Mohammad Sadiq
(B) Mufti Mohammad Sayeed
(C) Sheikh Abdullah
(D) Farooq Abdullah

Q4. Which accord of 1974 between Indira Gandhi and Sheikh Abdullah made Abdullah the Chief Minister of Jammu and Kashmir?

(A) Simla Agreement
(B) Punjab Accord
(C) Indira–Sheikh Accord
(D) Tashkent Agreement

Q5. The Punjabi Suba demand was made mainly by which party?

(A) Akali Dal
(B) Congress
(C) Jana Sangh
(D) Communist Party

Q6. The Anandpur Sahib Resolution of 1973 mainly asserted:

(A) Adoption of Hindi as the only language of Punjab
(B) Regional autonomy and a redefinition of Centre–State relations
(C) Abolition of the Akali Dal
(D) Merger of Punjab with Haryana

Q7. 'Operation Blue Star' (June 1984) was carried out against militants led by:

(A) Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale
(B) Master Tara Singh
(C) Harchand Singh Longowal
(D) Sant Fateh Singh

Q8. Indira Gandhi was assassinated on 31 October 1984 by:

(A) A Kashmir separatist
(B) Naxalite militants
(C) An Assam agitator
(D) Her own bodyguards

Q9. The 1985 Punjab Accord was signed by Rajiv Gandhi and:

(A) Zail Singh
(B) Parkash Singh Badal
(C) Sant Bhindranwale
(D) Harchand Singh Longowal

Q10. The Assam Movement (1979–85) led by AASU was directed against:

(A) Creation of Meghalaya
(B) Imposition of Hindi
(C) Illegal migrants (foreigners), mainly from Bangladesh
(D) Nationalisation of tea gardens

Q11. The Assam Accord of 1985 was signed between the Union Government (Rajiv Gandhi) and:

(A) The Mizo National Front
(B) AASU and the Assam Gana Sangram Parishad
(C) The Naga National Council
(D) The Akali Dal

Q12. Under the Assam Accord, foreigners who had entered Assam after which year were to be identified and deported?

(A) 1971
(B) 1985
(C) 1950
(D) 1947

Q13. The Mizo National Front (MNF) was led by:

(A) Laldenga
(B) Longowal
(C) Sheikh Abdullah
(D) Phizo

Q14. Mizoram became a full-fledged state in:

(A) 1972
(B) 1987
(C) 1975
(D) 1963

Q15. The Naga National Council, which demanded independence for Nagaland, was led by:

(A) Sheikh Abdullah
(B) Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale
(C) Angami Zapu Phizo
(D) Laldenga

Q16. Nagaland was made a state in:

(A) 1963
(B) 1987
(C) 1947
(D) 1972

Q17. In 1972 which of the following achieved statehood in the reorganisation of the North-East?

(A) Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura
(B) Nagaland and Sikkim
(C) Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh
(D) Assam and Goa

Q18. Sikkim became the 22nd state of India in:

(A) 1963
(B) 1947
(C) 1987
(D) 1975

Q19. Before its merger with India, Sikkim was a:

(A) Princely state of Hyderabad
(B) Protectorate of India
(C) Part of Assam
(D) Portuguese colony

Q20. The agitation of the Mizo Hills in the 1960s started after:

(A) The Emergency
(B) The partition of Bengal
(C) The Chinese war
(D) The 1959 famine and the government's response to it

Q21. The Dravidian movement in Tamil Nadu, which later gave rise to the DMK, was started by:

(A) E. V. Ramasamy 'Periyar'
(B) C. Rajagopalachari
(C) M. G. Ramachandran
(D) K. Kamaraj

Q22. Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram both became states in:

(A) 1975
(B) 1972
(C) 1987
(D) 1963

Q23. What is a key lesson regarding regional aspirations in the chapter?

(A) They are always a threat to be suppressed by force
(B) They disappear after economic growth
(C) They arise only in border states
(D) They are a part of democratic politics and are best handled by dialogue, accommodation and power-sharing

Q24. Which statement best describes the Indian approach to diversity?

(A) Banning regional parties
(B) Uniformity of language and culture
(C) Centralisation of all powers
(D) Unity in diversity through democratic accommodation of regional demands

Q25. In which year was the Farooq Abdullah government in Jammu and Kashmir dismissed, causing great resentment in the state?

(A) 1999
(B) 1984
(C) 1974
(D) 1953

Recent Developments in Indian Politics

Q1. In the 1984 Lok Sabha elections, held after Indira Gandhi's assassination, the Congress won:

(A) About 154 seats
(B) More than 400 seats
(C) About 330 seats
(D) About 283 seats

Q2. Who became Prime Minister of India after Indira Gandhi's assassination in 1984?

(A) Chandra Shekhar
(B) P. V. Narasimha Rao
(C) Rajiv Gandhi
(D) V. P. Singh

Q3. The Mandal Commission, set up in 1979, was chaired by:

(A) Justice Jagmohanlal Sinha
(B) Fazl Ali
(C) Kaka Kalelkar
(D) B. P. Mandal

Q4. The Mandal Commission recommended how much reservation for Other Backward Classes in government jobs?

(A) 27 per cent
(B) 10 per cent
(C) 50 per cent
(D) 15 per cent

Q5. The Mandal Commission recommendations were implemented in 1990 by the government of:

(A) Chandra Shekhar
(B) H. D. Deve Gowda
(C) Rajiv Gandhi
(D) V. P. Singh

Q6. The Supreme Court judgement of 1992 upholding OBC reservations is known as the:

(A) Shah Bano case
(B) Indra Sawhney case
(C) Golaknath case
(D) Kesavananda Bharati case

Q7. The Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) was formed under the leadership of:

(A) Mayawati
(B) Kanshi Ram
(C) Jagjivan Ram
(D) Ram Vilas Paswan

Q8. The Shah Bano case, which led to the Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Divorce) Act 1986, concerned:

(A) Reservation for OBCs
(B) Land reforms
(C) Maintenance for a divorced Muslim woman
(D) Press freedom

Q9. The Babri Masjid in Ayodhya was demolished on:

(A) 31 October 1984
(B) 6 December 1990
(C) 15 August 1992
(D) 6 December 1992

Q10. The 1990 Rath Yatra from Somnath to Ayodhya was led by:

(A) Murli Manohar Joshi
(B) V. P. Singh
(C) L. K. Advani
(D) Atal Bihari Vajpayee

Q11. The National Front government of 1989 headed by V. P. Singh was supported from outside by:

(A) The AIADMK only
(B) The Muslim League
(C) The BJP and the Left parties
(D) The Congress

Q12. Which scandal involving the purchase of field guns from a Swedish company damaged the Rajiv Gandhi government?

(A) Bofors scandal
(B) Harshad Mehta scam
(C) Fodder scam
(D) 2G scam

Q13. Rajiv Gandhi was assassinated in 1991 at:

(A) New Delhi
(B) Amritsar
(C) Sriperumbudur in Tamil Nadu
(D) Kolkata

Q14. New Economic Policy reforms of 1991 were introduced under Prime Minister:

(A) P. V. Narasimha Rao
(B) V. P. Singh
(C) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(D) Rajiv Gandhi

Q15. Who was the Finance Minister who introduced economic liberalisation in 1991?

(A) P. Chidambaram
(B) Manmohan Singh
(C) Pranab Mukherjee
(D) Yashwant Sinha

Q16. In 1996 the BJP emerged as the largest party but the Vajpayee government lasted only:

(A) 13 days
(B) 6 months
(C) 5 years
(D) 13 months

Q17. Which governments followed the 1996 elections, supported from outside by the Congress?

(A) The United Front governments of H. D. Deve Gowda and I. K. Gujral
(B) UPA governments
(C) Janata Party governments
(D) The National Front governments

Q18. The BJP was formed in 1980. It was the successor to which earlier party?

(A) Socialist Party
(B) Bharatiya Jana Sangh
(C) Hindu Mahasabha
(D) Swatantra Party

Q19. The National Democratic Alliance (NDA) government headed by Atal Bihari Vajpayee completed a full term during:

(A) 1999–2004
(B) 1989–91
(C) 1996–98
(D) 2004–09

Q20. The United Progressive Alliance (UPA) came to power in 2004 with which Prime Minister?

(A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(B) Sonia Gandhi
(C) P. Chidambaram
(D) Manmohan Singh

Q21. The 2002 Gujarat riots followed an attack on the:

(A) Parliament
(B) Red Fort
(C) Sabarmati Express at Godhra
(D) Akshardham temple

Q22. Which of the following is NOT one of the elements of the new political consensus identified in the chapter?

(A) Acceptance of the role of state-level parties in governance

(B) Acceptance of the political and social claims of backward castes

(C) Agreement on new economic policies

(D) Rejection of regional parties from national-level governance

Q23. The period from 1989 onwards is generally described as the era of:

(A) One-party dominance

(B) Military rule

(C) Presidential rule

(D) Coalition governments and multi-party politics

Q24. Which party led the National Front, a coalition formed after the 1989 elections?

(A) CPI(M)

(B) Janata Dal

(C) Congress

(D) BJP

Q25. BJP's ideology of cultural nationalism is known as:

(A) Hindutva

(B) Socialism

(C) Secularism

(D) Gandhism

Chapter 1: Challenges of Nation Building

Q1: C	Q6: C	Q11: B	Q16: A	Q21: D
Q2: C	Q7: B	Q12: D	Q17: A	Q22: A
Q3: C	Q8: B	Q13: C	Q18: A	Q23: B
Q4: B	Q9: D	Q14: C	Q19: A	Q24: A
Q5: B	Q10: D	Q15: D	Q20: A	Q25: D

Chapter 2: Era of One-Party Dominance

Q1: D	Q6: A	Q11: C	Q16: B	Q21: C
Q2: C	Q7: C	Q12: C	Q17: B	Q22: C
Q3: D	Q8: B	Q13: D	Q18: A	Q23: A
Q4: D	Q9: D	Q14: B	Q19: A	Q24: A
Q5: B	Q10: A	Q15: A	Q20: B	Q25: D

Chapter 3: Politics of Planned Development

Q1: B	Q6: D	Q11: A	Q16: C	Q21: D
Q2: B	Q7: A	Q12: D	Q17: A	Q22: B
Q3: C	Q8: A	Q13: D	Q18: C	Q23: C
Q4: A	Q9: B	Q14: A	Q19: A	Q24: B
Q5: C	Q10: C	Q15: D	Q20: B	Q25: D

Chapter 4: India's External Relations

Q1: A	Q6: C	Q11: C	Q16: C	Q21: A
Q2: D	Q7: B	Q12: A	Q17: A	Q22: B
Q3: A	Q8: C	Q13: C	Q18: B	Q23: A
Q4: D	Q9: B	Q14: C	Q19: D	Q24: B
Q5: D	Q10: A	Q15: D	Q20: B	Q25: D

Chapter 5: Challenges to and Restoration of the Congress System

Q1: A	Q6: C	Q11: B	Q16: C	Q21: D
Q2: D	Q7: B	Q12: D	Q17: A	Q22: B
Q3: B	Q8: A	Q13: C	Q18: C	Q23: B
Q4: A	Q9: C	Q14: D	Q19: B	Q24: A
Q5: D	Q10: D	Q15: C	Q20: A	Q25: A

Chapter 6: The Crisis of Democratic Order

Q1: C	Q6: D	Q11: D	Q16: C	Q21: B
Q2: D	Q7: A	Q12: C	Q17: A	Q22: B
Q3: A	Q8: A	Q13: B	Q18: C	Q23: B
Q4: B	Q9: B	Q14: D	Q19: D	Q24: D
Q5: A	Q10: C	Q15: A	Q20: A	Q25: C

Chapter 7: Regional Aspirations

Q1: C	Q6: B	Q11: B	Q16: A	Q21: A
Q2: B	Q7: A	Q12: A	Q17: A	Q22: C
Q3: C	Q8: D	Q13: A	Q18: D	Q23: D
Q4: C	Q9: D	Q14: B	Q19: B	Q24: D
Q5: A	Q10: C	Q15: C	Q20: D	Q25: B

Chapter 8: Recent Developments in Indian Politics

Q1: B	Q6: B	Q11: C	Q16: A	Q21: C
Q2: C	Q7: B	Q12: A	Q17: A	Q22: D
Q3: D	Q8: C	Q13: C	Q18: B	Q23: D
Q4: A	Q9: D	Q14: A	Q19: A	Q24: B
Q5: D	Q10: C	Q15: B	Q20: D	Q25: A